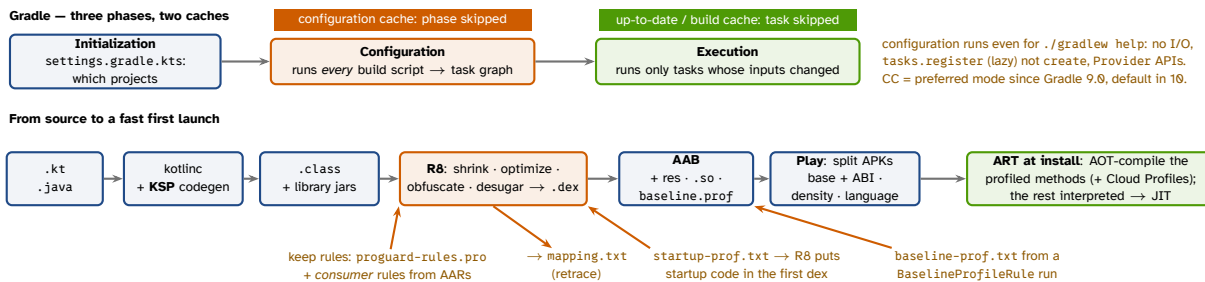


In one line: A release build is **Gradle** (configure a task graph, then run only out-of-date tasks) driving **kotlinc/KSP** → **R8** → **dex** → **AAB**; Play splits it per device. At runtime ART **interprets/JITs** unbundled code such as Compose, so a **Baseline Profile** tells it what to compile **ahead of time** at install. Prove every win with **Macrobenchmark** + **Perfetto**.



Gradle & AGP

- Config cache** (org.gradle.configuration-cache=true) stores the task graph; **build cache** (org.gradle.caching=true, local or remote) stores task outputs keyed by input hashes — CI shares them.
- Version catalog** gradle/libs.versions.toml → libs.hilt.android; **convention plugins** (included build-logic build) share module setup.
- api leaks a dependency to consumers → wider recompiles; prefer implementation.
- KSP** over **kapt** (Java stubs, maintenance mode): up to 2× faster — but one kapt processor left keeps stubs for the module.
- AGP 9:** Kotlin built in (no kotlin-android plugin), new DSL only, Gradle ≥ 9.1.

R8 — full mode (default since AGP 8.0)

- Tree-shakes from entry points (manifest, keep rules), inlines, merges classes, renames; unused resources go too (AGP 9: optimized resource shrinking).
- Full mode vs compat: a kept class **no longer keeps its default constructor**; Signature/annotations kept **only for kept items** even with -keepattributes — Gson TokenType, Retrofit generics break.
- keep (name + existence) · -keepclassmembers (members if class survives) · -keepnames/, allowshrinking (rename no, remove yes) · -if (conditional). Libraries ship consumerProguardFiles.

Example — build config

```
# gradle.properties
org.gradle.configuration-cache=true
org.gradle.caching=true
// app/build.gradle.kts
android { buildTypes { release {
    isMinifyEnabled = true; isShrinkResources = true
    proguardFiles(getDefaultProguardFile(
        "proguard-android-optimize.txt"), "proguard-rules.pro") } } }
dependencies {
    ksp(libs.hilt.compiler) // not kapt
    implementation(libs.androidx.profileinstaller)
    baselineProfile(project(":baselineprofile")) }
# proguard-rules.pro (Gson in full mode)
-keepclassmembers,allowobfuscation class * {
    @com.google.gson.annotations.SerializedName <fields>; }
```

Traps

- ! Timing a *debug* build — no R8, no AOT: meaningless numbers.
- ! A stale profile silently loses its gain — benchmark it in CI.
- ! “R8 broke my app” — it removed what only reflection used; add a keep rule, don’t disable minify.

Baseline & Startup Profiles

- Compose/AndroidX are *libraries*, not in the OS image: first runs are interpreted/JIT’d. A **Baseline Profile** lists hot classes/methods; ART AOT-compiles them at install — about **30%** faster from the first launch. Play ships it; ProfileInstaller covers sideloads.
- Generate with BaselineProfileRule().collect(pkg) { ... } over startup + key journeys (generateBaselineProfile); regenerate per release.
- Startup Profile** (includeInStartupProfile = true): R8 lays startup code into the primary dex — about **15%** more.
- Cloud Profiles** (API 28+) come later from real users.

Measure — benchmarks & Perfetto

- Macrobenchmark:** own module drives the installed, non-debuggable profileable app — StartupTimingMetric, FrameTimingMetric; StartupMode.COLD; CompilationMode.None() vs Partial() proves the profile. **Micro:** BenchmarkRule, one function.
- Perfetto** system trace → ui.perfetto.dev; trace("load"){...} marks code; read bindApplication, doFrame, lock/binder waits.

Startup — the numbers

- Cold:** new process · **warm:** process alive, Activity re-created · **hot:** Activity brought to front. Optimise for cold.
- TTID** = first frame, logged automatically (Displayed ... +480ms); **TTFD** = when you call reportFullyDrawn() (Compose: ReportDrawnWhen { loaded }).
- Vitals “excessive”: cold ≥ **5 s**, warm ≥ **2 s**, hot ≥ **1.5 s**. Frames: >16 ms (60 Hz) slow, >700 ms frozen.
- Fixes: nothing blocking in Application.onCreate, lazy SDK init, profiles.

Remember: *configure cheap, execute cached · R8 keeps what it sees · profile → AOT at install · measure release + cold.*